

AI Basics Cheat Sheet

Your Quick Reference Guide to Artificial Intelligence

What is AI?

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is technology that can:

- Understand and generate human language
- Recognize patterns in data
- Make predictions and suggestions
- Learn from examples

Think of it as: Very smart autocomplete that has read millions of books, articles, and websites.

Common AI Terms

Term	What It Means
ChatGPT	AI chatbot by OpenAI - like texting with a smart assistant
Claude	AI assistant by Anthropic - designed to be helpful, harmless, and honest
Prompt	The question or instruction you give to AI
Large Language Model (LLM)	The technology behind AI chatbots - trained on huge amounts of text
Hallucination	When AI makes up false information confidently

Training Data	The information AI learned from (text, images, etc.)
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What AI CAN Do

✅ Write and edit text (emails, letters, essays) ✅ Explain complex topics simply ✅
Brainstorm ideas and solve problems ✅ Translate languages ✅ Summarize long
documents ✅ Create study guides and learning materials ✅ Generate code and debug
programs ✅ Answer general knowledge questions

What AI CANNOT Do

❌ Access the internet in real-time (unless specifically enabled) ❌ Remember previous
conversations (each chat is fresh) ❌ Know personal information about you ❌ Replace
professional advice (medical, legal, financial) ❌ Understand emotions or context
perfectly ❌ Always be 100% accurate

Safety Rules

🚫 NEVER Share:

- Full names and addresses
- Phone numbers or email addresses
- Passwords or login credentials
- Bank account or credit card details
- Social Security or National Insurance numbers
- Medical record numbers
- School or workplace names with identifying details

🟢 ALWAYS:

- Fact-check important information
- Use AI as a first draft, not final answer

- Teach children to think critically
 - Review before sharing AI-generated content
 - Remember: AI can make mistakes
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The Golden Rule

AI is your first draft, not your final answer.

Always review, verify, and add your own thinking!

Getting Started

1. Choose a Platform

- Claude.ai (our recommendation)
- ChatGPT
- Other AI assistants

2. Start Simple

- Try: "Explain [topic] to me like I'm 10 years old"
- Or: "Help me write an email about [situation]"

3. Be Specific

- Vague: "Help me plan dinner"
- Better: "Suggest a healthy dinner for 4 people, vegetarian, budget £20"

4. Iterate

- If the first response isn't perfect, ask follow-up questions
 - "Can you make it shorter/longer/simpler?"
 - "Can you focus more on [specific aspect]?"
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Example Prompts to Try

For Writing: "Help me write a polite email to [person] about [topic]. Keep it professional but friendly."

For Learning: "Explain how [concept] works in simple terms with a real-world example."

For Planning: "Create a weekly meal plan for [number] people with [dietary requirements] and budget of [amount]."

For Problem-Solving: "I need to [goal] but I'm struggling with [obstacle]. What are some strategies?"

Red Flags - When AI Gets It Wrong

▶ **Claims something is 100% certain** (nothing is!) ▶ **Provides very specific numbers** without sources ▶ **Gives medical/legal advice** (needs professional verification) ▶ **Contradicts itself** in the same conversation ▶ **Can't explain its reasoning** clearly

Family AI Agreement Checklist

☐ We will only use AI for appropriate tasks ☐ We won't share personal information ☐ We'll fact-check important information ☐ We'll use AI to learn, not to cheat ☐ We'll discuss concerns openly ☐ We'll respect privacy and copyright

Need Help?

 Visit: alongside-ai-basics.netlify.app  Learn More: theaiark.org

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